

Daniel Dai

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EDUCATION

University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign (UIUC)

Master of Computer Science, Artificial Intelligence & Data Science Tracks

Online

May 2024 – Dec. 2026 (Expected)

University of California, Los Angeles (UCLA)

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science, 3.84 GPA

Los Angeles, CA

Sep. 2020 – Dec. 2023

EXPERIENCE

Software Development Engineer in Test

Apple

Aug. 2025 – Present

Cupertino, CA

- Building a full-stack dashboard with React, FastAPI, and PostgreSQL to aggregate and visualize 20,000+ Bluetooth accessory test results, enabling faster failure triage and trend analysis
- Automated Apple Wallet car key testing for Low Power Mode in Python, reducing manual regression time by 70%
- Built a Claude-powered analytics skill adopted across the org that translates natural language questions into database queries and returns analyzed results, turning days of data exploration into minutes

Software Engineer

TikTok

Feb. 2024 – Aug. 2025

San Jose, CA

- Designed and built a REST API integrating ticketing platforms like Eventbrite into TikTok, using Go microservices and Redis caching to serve 100 million daily impressions and 200,000 daily active users
- Implemented a data ingestion system and recommendation algorithms that process 2 million external tickets
- Revamped MongoDB schema to improve flexibility, reducing storage size by 21% and query latency by up to 50%
- Strengthened team infrastructure by developing metrics dashboards and integrating unit tests into CI/CD

Software Engineer Intern

TikTok

June 2023 – Sep. 2023

San Jose, CA

- Developed an analytics platform for external developers to optimize their usage of TikTok Developer APIs
- Designed an ETL pipeline to process 130 million daily API logs, using SQL indexes to optimize query performance
- Implemented a Go-based REST API endpoint with Redis caching for low-latency analytics data retrieval

Software Engineer Intern

Cox Automotive

June 2022 – Sep. 2022

Irvine, CA

- Implemented a mobile-responsive layout for Kelley Blue Book's "Shop Smart" module using React, Node.js, and CSS, achieving a 171% increase in click-through rates through A/B testing with Optimizely
- Integrated 30 Cypress end-to-end tests into CI/CD using AWS CodeBuild, enhancing deployment confidence

PROJECTS

BruinShack (now UniShack) | HTML, CSS, JavaScript, Vue.js

June 2021 – Mar. 2022

- Rebuilt the apartment listing creation UI with Vue.js and CSS, reducing the average task completion time by 40%
- Integrated interactive carousels, modals, and forms with REST APIs for seamless account and listing management

Grades of Green Learning Management System | HTML, CSS, JavaScript

Sep. 2021 – June 2023

- Led a team of 8 in developing an LMS that empowers 670,000 students to create and share environmental projects
- Collaborated cross-functionally to design prototypes in Figma and develop the frontend using HTML, CSS, and JS

Covalent | HTML, CSS, JavaScript, React, Next.js, GraphQL, AWS

June 2020 – May 2021

- Built a React and Next.js web app with icebreaking games like "2 Truths and a Lie" to help remote teams bond
- Launched on Product Hunt, earning 300 upvotes, and won "Best Large Team" at the 2021 ACM Tech Gala

SKILLS

Languages: Python, Go, JavaScript, SQL, GraphQL, C, C++, Bash, HTML, CSS

Frameworks: React.js, Next.js, Vue.js, Node.js, FastAPI, Tailwind CSS, Cypress

AI/LLM: Claude (agent skills, tool use), LLM-powered analytics, prompt engineering

Cloud & Data: AWS, Google Cloud, Docker, CI/CD (GitHub Actions), PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Redis